



Kumar Mangalam Birla,
Chairman, Aditya Birla Group



N. Srinivasan, Vice Chairman &
MD, India Cements

14 |

In a report put out right after the UltraTech-India Cements deal, financial services and research firm Emkay Global says, “We believe this deal is a precursor to UltraTech ultimately increasing its stake and converting it into a strategic investment ahead. The top groups (especially UltraTech and Adani) are in the race for capacity expansion/market share gains, accelerating the consolidation trend in the sector and boosting valuations of small-to-mid-size cement players.”

In the race for capacity expansion in the southern part of India, expect more activity in the space. **BT**

@krishnagopalan

GST COUNCIL

Some Hits, Some Misses

The GST Council meeting took care of procedural matters, but some big decisions are awaited

BY SURABHI

PHOTO BY ANI



FULL SPEED AHEAD The GST Council, headed by Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, is picking up from where it left off

► **AFTER A GAP** of over eight months, the Goods and Services Tax (GST) Council met on June 22. Coming as it did after a brief hiatus brought about by the General Elections, the meeting was keenly awaited by trade and industry, which was hoping for clarity on many issues.

The Council, chaired by Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman with representatives from all states—including as many as 11 new members—clearly had a busy agenda and announced as many as 52 decisions. Almost all of them were procedural and compliance-